



FEDERATION OF CANADIAN SECONDARY STUDENTS
FÉDÉRATION DES ÉLÈVES DU SECONDAIRE AU CANADA

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2025-2026 JEDI CHAMPIONS REPORT

Dear GLOCAL Team:

It is my pleasure to share the 2025—2026 JEDI Champions Program report of the Federation of Canadian Secondary Students / Fédération des élèves du secondaire au Canada (FCSS-FESC), an overview of the initiative's activities over the past six months from October 2024 to March 2025.

This year, our team significantly expanded its direct engagement with students across Canada, being able to successfully reach over 35 student signups from across Canada. We saw significant participant engagement rates with training modules, workshops, and quizzes, and were able to approve a diverse array of project proposals that fought for systemic, grassroots change through a number of innovative ideas.

This report will highlight in detail the workings of our JEDI Champions Program, and the integral support GLOCAL has played in its undertaking.

Sincerely,

Victor Jiang

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Introduction to the JEDI Champions Program

The JEDI Champions Program (short for justice, equity, decolonization, and inclusion) was launched as FCSS-FESC's flagship program this year in order to empower youth to advocate for social justice within their schools, neighbourhoods, and communities. Over the past six months, the program has successfully trained and helped dozens of students develop grassroots projects that have on aggregate benefited thousands of individuals across Canada.

This strongly aligned with FCSS-FESC's core values of working in anti-oppressional frameworks to support underserved populations, especially in having a greater say in leadership and decision making processes. We also helped engage students in quality social justice, governance, and advocacy training, while developing comprehensive, lifelong skills.

We applied for GLOCAL's CANConnect Micro-Grant Diversity Program to cover important, necessary expenses relevant to our JEDI Champions Program. We believed this initiative had a very robust alignment with the goals of GLOCAL in actively promoting civic awareness and democratic literacy within our training modules and the process of developing solution proposals. With the generous funding provided by GLOCAL, we were able to expand the program's reach and provide important resources for our participants.

Program Objectives and Scope

The program targeted highschool students, and had success in recruiting a diverse participant pool. A majority of students recruited were between the ages of 14-16, attending secondary schools within Ontario, Canada. All participants were required to complete 12 training modules in order to develop and demonstrate skills such as outreach, grant writing, sponsorship acquisition and event planning. This prepared them for leadership roles within their schools and communities, equipping them with the tools necessary to drive meaningful change.

Following that, students underwent a rigorous process to brainstorm and flesh out their project proposals. With quality support from our JEDI Program Coordinators and FCSS-FESC team, students received feedback, redrafted, and finally began implementing their innovative solutions within their communities. Some of these projects have reached completion at this date. Yet, as a result of our robust support through the seed stages of development, many initiatives will likely be autonomously run in the future, creating further long-lasting change beyond this report.

Impact and Outcomes

The program successfully reached 36 students, with individual projects focusing on anti-racism, environmental sustainability and equity within academia. 33 project proposals were approved,

several of which have been completed already or are nearing completion. Informal feedback also reports a variety of positive experiences from our JEDI Champions participants to our Program Coordinators, primarily indicating that the program has contributed to their personal development. We will likely measure further data more comprehensively in the future, as our program is still in its concluding stage.

Financial Overview

The \$500.00 CAD in funds provided by The GLOCAL Foundation of Canada were essential in supporting the JEDI Champions Program and its success. All funding was directly allocated to program expenses, such as marketing materials (notably posters and other physical items), participant resources, and participant merchandise. These enabled us to increase the reach of our program, as well as supply JEDI Champions with the resources they needed in order to succeed.

While we did not receive the full \$5,000.00 micro-grant and were not able to cover our full budget with only GLOCAL's contributions, funds were still carefully distributed in order to maximize impact in delivering a quality experience for all participants.

Areas for Improvement

This year, though the JEDI Champions Program was overall quite successful, the program faced challenges with supporting more high-impact projects. Often, we were forced to cut back the scale of more ambitious (but possible) projects due to lack of funding. As lessons learned for the future, we would understand the importance of allocating more time and resources towards fostering thorough, careful, and in-depth ideation processes for the program participants to avoid similar hurdles next year.

Moreover, in the long-term, additional funding as well as more thorough planning may allow us to take this program to greater heights such as through creating in-person initiatives and getting larger school boards, politicians, and remarkable figures involved.

Closing Remarks

In the 2025-2026 operational year, the Federation will place a key focus on increasing outreach and further expanding our JEDI Champions Program through rigorous marketing efforts. We will also focus more of our funds and resources to operating the JEDI Champions programs, especially toward high-impact projects and new innovative strategies in ways that more effectively catalyze grassroots social justice advocacy in communities across Canada.

Questions about the report can be directed to the attention of the Chief Financial Officer at finance@fcss-fesc.ca